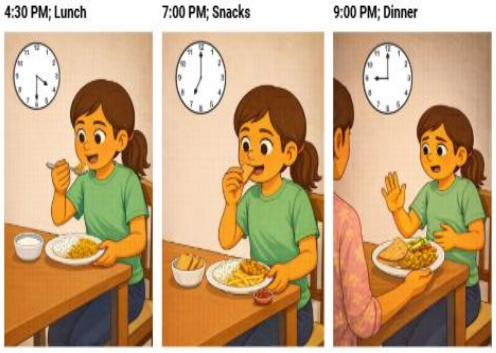
Habit 1: Respect Mealtimes

1.1 Why Meal Timing Is Important

"Observe this child. What do you believe is occurring?" Expected Student Responses:

- The child is refusing to eat breakfast before going to school
- Her mother is offering her breakfast



"Observe this child now. What do you believe is occurring?" Expected Student Responses:

- She eats her lunch very late, around 4:30 pm
- She eats snacks like French fries, cookies, or popcorn around 7:00 pm
- Because she is full from snacks, she refuses to eat dinner at 9:00 pm

Follow-up Question: "What could be the reason she is not eating her dinner?"

Expected Student Response**:** She has already eaten too many snacks late in the evening

Explain that skipping meals, eating too late, or snacking all the time confuses the body. This can make us feel tired and low on energy

- Eating right is not only about what we eat, but also when we eat

Eating meals on time helps the body stay strong, active, and focused. Our body follows a natural body clock that works best with regular meal timings

1.2 Importance of Breakfast

Classroom Questions: Warm-Up and Classroom engagement

1. How many of you had breakfast today?
2. How many meals do you eat in a day?

Then, tell them breakfast is the most important meal of the day.

- It breaks the overnight fast
- It refuels the body with glucose for energy
- It improves alertness, focus, and learning
- It provides essential nutrients for a healthy start

We should choose whole, homemade breakfast options (made with minimal oil) like:

- Poha with peanuts and vegetables
- Paneer-stuffed besan cheela with curd
- Fruit and nut smoothie
- Besan chilla with vegetables
- Upma with carrots and peas

Introduce the Habit Challenge: Breakfast on Time

Tell them to take the 7-day challenge:

- Eat breakfast within one hour of waking up
- Do not skip breakfast on any day

1.3 Eating the Right Number of Meals

Classroom Questions

1. How many mini-meals do you eat in a day?
2. Can you name one snack you usually eat randomly?

Explain the importance of eating 3 main meals every day: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

- Eat lunch around mid-day, make it the heaviest meal of the day. It provides sustained energy for daily activities
- Eat dinner by 8:00–8:30 pm, eat at least 2 hours before bedtime. Keep dinner light and easy to digest

Mini Meals (2 per day)

- One mini meal between breakfast and lunch (11:00–12:00 noon)
- One mini meal in the evening at tea time
- Mini meals help maintain energy and prevent overeating

Tell them to Choose Smart Snacks: ✓ Fruits, ✓ Dry fruits, ✓ Curd, ✓ Sprouts, ✓ Homemade chikkis, ✓ Roasted foxnuts (makhana), ✓ Baked muffins

✕ Avoid chips, candies, colas, and packaged junk foods

Recap: Key Takeaways

Conclude the lesson by summarizing the three main practices:

- Eat meals on time every day
- Never skip breakfast
- Choose healthy snacks instead of junk food

Finally, instruct students to revise at home, discuss what they learned with their parents, read the overview in the workbook, and complete the exercises given.